

Things of Systemic Importance to Tribal Nations and Similar-Sized Geopolitical Entities

The physics of sovereignty, and the substrate of nationhood

Onri Jay Benally

Field-practical systems view

January 25, 2026

Scope and intent

Core claim

Sovereignty behaves as a *systems property*. Therefore, stability emerges when a nation maintains its own substrate. In practice, this means the physical, biological, cognitive, ecological, temporal, human, and legal layers allow ordinary operations to continue under stress.

Audience fit

This document targets Tribal Nations and similar-sized geopolitical entities (city-states, autonomous regions, island nations), especially when governance occurs under infrastructure constraints, and when jurisdiction must be continuously demonstrated through reliable services.

Roadmap

- 1 Framing: the physics of sovereignty
- 2 I. The physical substrate: stable roads
- 3 II. The biological substrate: clean water access
- 4 III. The cognitive substrate: language and linguistics
- 5 IV. The ecological substrate: landscape and energy independence
- 6 V. The temporal substrate: transparent history
- 7 VI. The human substrate: veterans as capacity
- 8 VII. The legal substrate: protections that prevent cascades
- 9 VIII. Scaling competence: a nation-building model
- 10 Etymologies and glossary
- 11 References and license

From qubits to nations: coherence needs a substrate

Just as a qubit needs shielding from noise to stay coherent, a nation needs stable roads, clean water, and trustworthy institutions to keep decision-making coherent under routine stress and crisis stress.

Complex systems fail through cascades. Consequently, sovereignty can be modeled as a set of coupled control loops (resource flows, enforcement, measurement, legitimacy). When the underlying substrate is under-specified, control authority becomes nominal rather than operational, and the entity remains externally dependent.

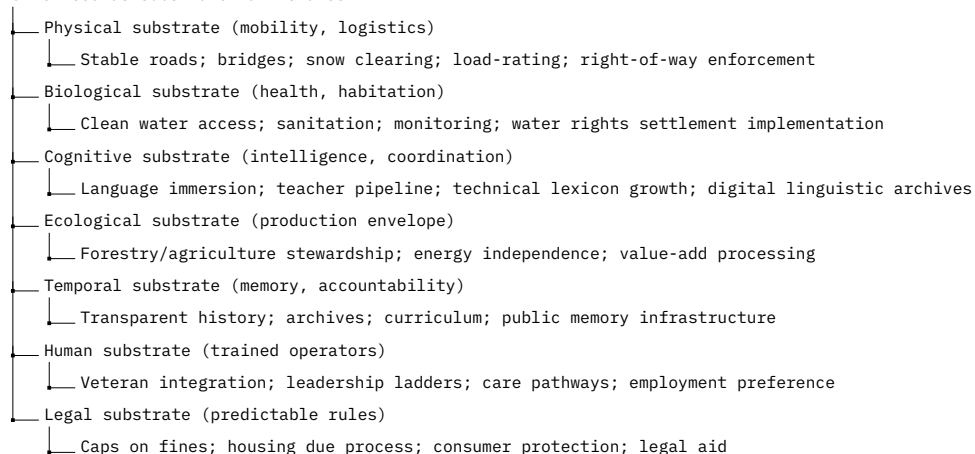
Lens attribution and background context are discussed in [\[1\]](#), [\[2\]](#), [\[3\]](#), [\[4\]](#), [\[5\]](#).

Seven pillars

Pillar	What it stabilizes	Representative mechanisms
Stable roads	Movement, commerce, emergency access	Maintenance capacity, force-account crews, compacts
Clean water access	Health, housing, industry enablement	Decentralized sanitation, monitoring, settlements
Language & linguistics resources	Cognition, identity, intergenerational transmission	Immersion, teacher pipelines, sovereign archives
Landscape resources	Long-run revenue and resilience	Sustained-yield stewardship, value-add production, microgrids
Transparent history	Legitimacy, accountability, healing	Digital repatriation, curriculum sovereignty, public memory
Veteran resources	Leadership and technical human capital	Preference laws, service officers, integrated care pathways
Homeowner & veteran protections	Social stability and justice	Caps on fines, due process housing rules, legal aid

Classification tree: substrate-of-nationhood map

Nationhood as substrate maintenance



Roads as jurisdiction made visible

Roads function like arteries; blocked arteries create paralysis. Thus, road reliability directly shapes whether services and commerce continue through winter storms, floods, and routine wear.

Road stability depends on geology, hydrology, and loading. Effectively, a “stable road” is an engineered boundary condition: slope stability, drainage integrity, surfacing selection, and maintenance cadence together define the probability of failure for each segment. Forest-road research emphasizes terrain interpretation and materials awareness as operational determinants of performance [6], [7].

Comparative road maintenance models in Tribal jurisdictions

Model	Description	Sovereignty	Risk/ responsibility
Federal direct service	Bureau of Indian Affairs or federal agency retains control and performs maintenance	Low	Federal agency assumes risk; Tribe has limited priority control
638 contract (Public Law 93-638)	Tribe performs specific functions under federal standards	Medium	Tribe gains operational experience; federal oversight remains
Self-governance compact	Tribe assumes control over funding and decisions, treating funding as a block grant	High	Tribe assumes liability and strategic control; local prioritization increases
Force account	Tribe uses its own crews and equipment rather than outsourcing	High	Internal capacity grows, wages remain local; capital equipment required

Case study: Citizen Potawatomi Nation (CPN) and regional integration

Why it matters

Compacts convert external programs into internal operating authority. The Citizen Potawatomi Nation example illustrates how transportation governance can create both physical benefits and political goodwill [8].

Observed pattern

Through a comprehensive compact with the U.S. Department of Transportation (2024), CPN gained increased control, flexibility, and decision authority over transportation funding and operations [8].

Through county partnerships (for example, the Hardesty Road improvement), CPN translated tribal capacity into regional benefit, while also generating durable political capital [9].

Through safety-sidewalk projects in commercial corridors, “stable roads” became a multimodal access strategy rather than a pavement-only strategy [8], [9].

Implementation ladder: from potholes to policy

1. **Assess and inventory:** Terrain and drainage dominate failure; map assets and classify segments by stability drivers (soil, slope, hydrology) [7].
2. **Build force-account capacity:** Waiting for contractors increases downtime. Acquire a minimal fleet and train local crews for rapid repair and storm response.
3. **Expand jurisdiction:** Maintaining an arterial road effectively demonstrates ownership. Pursue compacts and intergovernmental agreements for key corridors [8].

The hydrology of justice (water as a nation-enabler)

Water is required for housing, schools, clinics, and businesses; unreliable water access collapses development even when other resources exist.

Legal rights without delivery infrastructure remain “paper water.” Water sovereignty requires a dual track: legal settlement and technical delivery. In Indian Country and in the Colorado River Basin context, program materials and reporting highlight that Navajo residents face dramatically higher rates of lacking piped water, which operationally changes health risk and economic feasibility [10], [11], [12].

Decentralized sanitation: the Portable Alternative Sanitation System (PASS)

Case study: Kivalina, Alaska

Centralized pipe systems can exceed feasible cost in remote regions. The Portable Alternative Sanitation System (PASS) demonstrates a household-level, closed-loop approach that can move with families under relocation pressure [13].

System properties

Separates liquid and solid waste, and thereby reduces odor and handling exposure while improving hygiene outcomes [13].

Uses locally feasible water supply approaches and in-home treatment components, and thereby increases dignity and reduces pathogen contact [13], [14].

Remains portable, and thereby becomes infrastructure that can travel with climate-driven resettlement [13].

Water rights settlements: converting paper rights into wet water

Case study: Confederated Salish and Kootenai Tribes (CSKT) compact

Quantified rights reduce uncertainty for all users, and settlements can unlock capital for infrastructure modernization. The CSKT water compact illustrates legal sovereignty and regional stabilization as a coupled outcome [15], [16], [17].

Mechanisms to emulate

Quantify and document rights through negotiated settlement, and thereby reduce long-run litigation costs [16];

Pair settlement with rehabilitation funding for aging delivery infrastructure, and thereby increase efficiency and reliability [17].

Scaling water security: three simultaneous moves

1. **Immediate dignity:** deploy decentralized systems where pipes remain infeasible, and thereby reduce preventable disease burden [13].
2. **Data sovereignty:** install monitoring stations and build local hydrology capacity, and thereby negotiate from measured reality rather than inferred scarcity.
3. **Compact strategy:** negotiate settlements that translate seniority into enforceable deliveries and modernization funding [16], [17].

Language as a technology of intelligence

Language shapes what is easy to say. Since what is easy to say becomes easy to think, language functions as a cognitive tool rather than only a cultural marker.

Languages encode categories for space, time, agency, and causality. A language revival effectively preserves a distinct model of reality, and thereby preserves a distinct innovation surface. Context on technical translation and “substrate for thought” framing is discussed in [3], [4].

Immersion as infrastructure: Cherokee Nation teacher pipeline

Case study highlights

Teacher Institute of Excellence: Fluent teachers are a supply chain; a paid, full-time training pipeline increases throughput and stabilizes quality [18].

Education governance: Accreditation authority shapes curriculum reality. Tribal Educational Agency moves strengthen curriculum sovereignty and cultural alignment [19].

Built environment: Architecture reinforces worldview. Purpose-built facilities can materially support immersion routines [19].

Digital linguistics: sovereign archives with access protocols

Mukurtu as a governance pattern

Knowledge may be seasonal, gendered, or initiation-bounded. A cultural archive needs access-control primitives that respect community law. Mukurtu (Content Management System) was built with Indigenous communities and supports granular cultural protocols [20], [21].

Implementation ladder

1. Secure the archive (digitize audio, texts, and lexicons) [20];
2. Build the pipeline (pay teachers as cognitive engineers) [18];
3. Build the sanctuary (immersion environments where the language becomes the default operating system).

Landscape resources: extraction versus stewardship

Land provides food, materials, and energy. A nation that manages its landscape responsibly can fund services without consuming its own future.

Landscape management is a long-horizon optimization. Sustained yield approaches convert ecological stability into financial stability, especially when value-added processing remains local [22], [23].

Sustained-yield forestry: the Menominee model

Key mechanisms

Never cut more than the forest grows, and thereby preserve the capital stock of timber [22], [23];

Vertically integrate through sawmills and branded products, and thereby capture the value chain locally [24];

Adapt silviculture for climate forcing and pests, and thereby maintain long-run yield under non-stationary conditions [25], [26].

Microgrids: energy sovereignty as a resilience service

Case study: Blue Lake Rancheria

Grid dependence concentrates vulnerability. Blue Lake Rancheria demonstrates a low-carbon microgrid that can island from the main utility grid and continue powering critical facilities during outages [27], [28].

Why it scales geopolitically

Through outage survival, the microgrid becomes regional critical infrastructure, and thereby increases political leverage [27], [29].

Through demand management and energy optimization, the microgrid can reduce costs and support financially durable operations [28], [30].

Food sovereignty: the landscape as pantry and public health tool

Operational thesis

Supply chains remain brittle, and diet patterns shape chronic disease burden. Consequently, localized food systems increase resilience and improve long-run healthcare costs, especially when procurement policies move institutional demand toward healthier options [31], [32].

Implementation cues

Map soils, water availability, and culturally anchored harvest cycles; then align schools, clinics, and community centers with local procurement pathways.

Transparent history as temporal sovereignty

Communities plan by remembering. A distorted record leads to distorted plans, and the future inherits the error.

Archives function as governance infrastructure; digital repatriation and protocol-based access become jurisdictional acts. Tooling patterns for community-controlled archives align with Mukurtu approaches [20], [21].

Curriculum sovereignty: teaching accurate Indigenous history

Smithsonian Native Knowledge 360 (NK360)

School curricula shape public legitimacy. NK360 materials provide structured resources for teaching Indigenous history in ways that prioritize continuity, resilience, and legal reality rather than “vanishing” narratives [33], [34].

Implementation cues

Establish internal curriculum review; then align textbooks, standards, and teacher training with local history, treaty context, and community priorities; then extend outward via state-level partnerships and mandates.

Public memory: monuments, names, and the mapped past

Landscapes function as external memory. Renaming, signage, and interpretive infrastructure can align public space with transparent history and community narrative. Practical guidance for cultural landscapes inventory and legacy recognition appears in [\[35\]](#), [\[36\]](#).

Veterans as technical and leadership human capital

Veterans often return with logistics skills, medical exposure, and leadership practice. They can accelerate local capacity building when pathways into employment and housing are clear.

Health system boundary condition

Fragmented care creates access gaps. Native veteran resources and disparity research emphasize the need for coordinated pathways and locally accessible services [37], [38], [39].

Coordination: Indian Health Service (IHS) and Veterans Affairs (VA)

Practical pattern

Reimbursement and eligibility complexity blocks care. Interagency tools and mapping initiatives can reduce friction by clarifying where eligible veterans can access services and how reimbursement flows can be aligned [40].

Implementation cues

Fund Tribal Veterans Service Officers as benefit navigators [41];
Establish local reimbursement pathways so care dollars remain local when clinical capacity exists.

Employment preference: integrating service ethos into governance

Navajo Nation preference pattern

Preference laws translate gratitude into structural opportunity. Navajo Nation policy materials and commentary discuss veteran preference approaches within employment frameworks [42], [43].

Implementation cues

Enact a binding Tribal Veteran Preference Act; then require compliance across tribal enterprises and contractors; then align training pipelines with the job families that most increase sovereign capacity (roads, utilities, archives, clinics).

Veteran housing and wraparound supports

Why housing is a sovereignty issue

Unstable housing degrades employment continuity and healthcare adherence. Veteran-focused supportive housing can function as a retention mechanism for hard-won human capital.

Example pathway: Lummi Nation supportive housing

Program materials describe wraparound supportive housing that integrates counseling and multi-service navigation, and thereby reduces recidivism into crisis cycles [44], [45]. Complementarily, legal-aid navigation resources for homeless veterans illustrate how benefits and representation can be treated as a local economic inflow and a stabilization service [46].

Fines as revenue: the justice trap

A small fine can snowball into debt, suspension, and job loss. A government that uses fines as revenue eventually weakens its own tax base and increases social instability.

Evidence and risk framing

Fines-and-fees systems can behave as predatory debt machines. Reports on fines and fees emphasize how punitive accumulation creates harmful downstream effects [47].

Caps on fines and ability-to-pay as stability engineering

Mechanism

Link civil fines to statutory maxima and require ability-to-pay considerations, thereby orienting enforcement toward correction and restitution rather than revenue. Tribal code examples include capped civil fine language [48]; additionally, the Indian Civil Rights Act frames constitutional rights constraints relevant to excessive fines in Tribal contexts [49].

Implementation cues

Code review, fee schedule simplification, and a transparent hearing process together reduce enforcement volatility, while also improving legitimacy and compliance.

Housing stability: due process as the anchor of the middle

Eviction protections

Housing displacement destabilizes employment and education. Codified eviction procedures that require hearings and writs can reduce arbitrary removal and increase predictability [50].

Crisis buffers

Shocks (pandemics, job loss, disasters) trigger foreclosure cascades. Federal programs such as the Homeowner Assistance Fund provide stabilization pathways that can be adapted and coordinated locally [51].

Consumer protection: anti-predatory lending as civimmunity

Mechanism

High-cost small-dollar credit can trap households in debt spirals. A sovereign jurisdiction can implement usury ceilings and licensing constraints, while also enabling safer alternatives through community development finance and employer-linked low-cost loans.

Practical heuristic

A frequently cited benchmark for small-loan consumer protection is an annual percentage rate (APR) cap near 36%, especially when fees are included transparently in the cap definition [52].

Scaling competence: from small feasible examples to full jurisdiction

Harvard Project alignment

Nation-building tends to proceed through institutions that match local priorities, and capacity can be grown through staged competence. Policy summaries linked to the Harvard Project emphasize the difference between externally driven development and governance-driven development [53], [54].

Three-phase scaling model

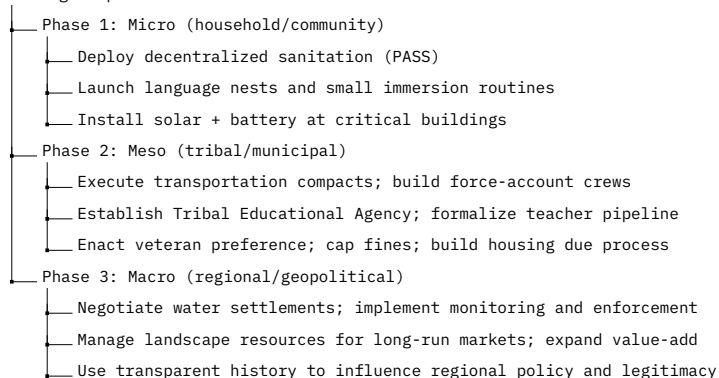
Micro (household/community): rapid wins that prove capability.

Meso (tribal/municipal): institutionalize capacity and assert jurisdiction.

Macro (regional/geopolitical): settlements, markets, and long-horizon stewardship.

Classification tree: scaling competence (micro, meso, macro)

Scaling competence model



A practical checklist

Question	Operational indicator (pass/fail leaning)
Can we restore mobility quickly?	Force-account crew exists; winter response plan exists; priority corridors defined
Can we deliver safe water this month?	Decentralized systems deployed; monitoring in place; rights plan exists
Can we transmit language to children daily?	Immersion environment exists; teachers paid; archive governed
Can we keep power on during outages?	Critical-building microgrid path exists; maintenance funded
Can we teach our own timeline?	Archive access rules exist; curriculum updated; public memory aligned
Can we integrate veterans into governance?	Service officers funded; preference law enforced; housing pathways defined
Can we prevent fines/housing cascades?	Caps, due process, consumer protection, and legal aid are operational

Etymologies

Sovereignty traces through Latin *superanus* (above, supreme), which foregrounds authority that sits “above” external command.

Substrate comes from Latin *substratum* (a layer spread under), which fits the “support layer” framing for governance.

Jurisdiction comes from Latin *jus* (law) + *dicere* (to say), which highlights that law becomes real when it is spoken and enforced.

Acronym glossary

BIA: Bureau of Indian Affairs.

CMS: Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services.

CPN: Citizen Potawatomi Nation.

CSKT: Confederated Salish and Kootenai Tribes.

GIS: Geographic Information System.

HAF: Homeowner Assistance Fund.

IHS: Indian Health Service.

NK360: Native Knowledge 360.

PASS: Portable Alternative Sanitation System.

PG&E: Pacific Gas & Electric.

TEA: Tribal Educational Agency.

TVSO: Tribal Veterans Service Officer.

USDA: United States Department of Agriculture.

References I

- [1] *About – onri jay benally - medium*, Accessed 2026-01-25. Accessed: Jan. 25, 2026. [Online]. Available: <https://medium.com/@ojb-quantum/about>.
- [2] *Onri jay benally - nano magnetism and quantum spintronics lab*, Accessed 2026-01-25. Accessed: Jan. 25, 2026. [Online]. Available: <https://nanospin.umn.edu/people/onri-jay-benally>.
- [3] *No philosophy without a substrate for thought | medium*, Accessed 2026-01-25. Accessed: Jan. 25, 2026. [Online]. Available: <https://medium.com/@ojb-quantum/no-philosophy-without-a-substrate-for-thought-80fd8aa834e4>.
- [4] *Making quantum leaps in learning with onrí jay benally - college of science & engineering*, Accessed 2026-01-25. Accessed: Jan. 25, 2026. [Online]. Available: <https://cse.umn.edu/ece/feature-stories/making-quantum-leaps-learning-onri-jay-benally>.

References II

- [5] *How being raised in a tribe led to studying quantum computers / barrington james*, Accessed 2026-01-25. Accessed: Jan. 25, 2026. [Online]. Available: <https://www.barringtonjames.com/resources/podcast/how-being-raised-raised-in-a-tribe-led-to-studying-quantum-computuers/>.
- [6] *Logging roads and protection of water quality - epa nepis*, Accessed 2026-01-25. Accessed: Jan. 25, 2026. [Online]. Available: <https://nepis.epa.gov/Exe/ZyPURL.cgi?Dockkey=2000BVQE.TXT>.
- [7] *Forest roads: A synthesis of scientific information*, Accessed 2026-01-25. Accessed: Jan. 25, 2026. [Online]. Available: https://www.fs.usda.gov/pnw/pubs/pnw_gtr509.pdf.

References III

- [8] *Cpn signs compact with u.s. department of transportation - potawatomi.org*, Accessed 2026-01-25. Accessed: Jan. 25, 2026. [Online]. Available: <https://www.potawatomi.org/blog/2024/05/27/cpn-signs-compact-with-u-s-department-of-transportation/>.
- [9] *Tribe, county partner to improve area infrastructure - potawatomi.org*, Accessed 2026-01-25. Accessed: Jan. 25, 2026. [Online]. Available: <https://www.potawatomi.org/blog/2022/12/08/tribe-county-partner-to-improve-area-infrastructure/>.
- [10] *Addressing tribal water justice through u of a programs and a new funding handbook*, Accessed 2026-01-25. Accessed: Jan. 25, 2026. [Online]. Available: <https://naair.arizona.edu/news/addressing-tribal-water-justice-through-u-programs-new-funding-handbook>.

References IV

- [11] *Native communities water access / u.s. department of the interior - doi gov*, Accessed 2026-01-25. Accessed: Jan. 25, 2026. [Online]. Available: <https://www.doi.gov/ocl/native-communities-water-access>.
- [12] *Helping tribal communities gain universal access to clean water - walton family foundation*, Accessed 2026-01-25. Accessed: Jan. 25, 2026. [Online]. Available: <https://www.waltonfamilyfoundation.org/stories/environment/helping-tribal-communities-gain-universal-access-to-clean-water>.
- [13] *Rural project summary: Portable alternative sanitation system (pass)*, Accessed 2026-01-25. Accessed: Jan. 25, 2026. [Online]. Available: <https://www.ruralhealthinfo.org/project-examples/933>.

References V

- [14] *Usda funding brings clean water, sanitation, into the rural village homes of alaska natives*, Accessed 2026-01-25. Accessed: Jan. 25, 2026. [Online]. Available: <https://www.usda.gov/about-usda/news/blog/usda-funding-brings-clean-water-sanitation-rural-village-homes-alaska-natives>.
- [15] *From lies to truth: Why the cskt water rights compact is good for montana*, Accessed 2026-01-25. Accessed: Jan. 25, 2026. [Online]. Available: https://archive.legmt.gov/content/Committees/Interim/2013-2014/Water-Policy/Meetings/September-2014/Lund-CSKT_compact.pdf.
- [16] *Cskt water compact implementation*, Accessed 2026-01-25. Accessed: Jan. 25, 2026. [Online]. Available: <https://csktwatercompact.com/>.

References VI

- [17] *Interior department executes water rights settlement agreement with the confederated salish & kootenai tribes of the flathead indian reservation - doi.gov*, Accessed 2026-01-25. Accessed: Jan. 25, 2026. [Online]. Available: <https://www.doi.gov/pressreleases/interior-department-executes-water-rights-settlement-agreement-confederated-salish>.
- [18] *Teacher institute of excellence - cherokee nation language department*, Accessed 2026-01-25. Accessed: Jan. 25, 2026. [Online]. Available: <https://language.cherokee.org/language-programs/teacher-institute-of-excellence/>.
- [19] *ᏍᏏᏅᏅᏍᏔ ᏍᏏᏅᏅᏍᏔ ᏍᏏ ᏍᏏᏅᏅᏅᏅᏅᏅ ᏍᏏᏅᏅ ᏍᏏᏅᏅ report on language education sel*, Accessed 2026-01-25. Accessed: Jan. 25, 2026. [Online]. Available: <https://language.cherokee.org/media/5wan5m52/report-on-language-ed-self-governance-2024-final.pdf>.

References VII

- [20] *Mukurtu cms | the free, mobile and open source platform built with indigenous communities to manage and share digital cultural heritage*, Accessed 2026-01-25. Accessed: Jan. 25, 2026. [Online]. Available: <https://mukurtu.org/>.
- [21] *Our archives, our stories - mukurtu cms*, Accessed 2026-01-25. Accessed: Jan. 25, 2026. [Online]. Available: <https://mukurtu.org/project/our-archives-our-stories/>.
- [22] *Forest management plan (revised 1973) 2012 - 2027 - menominee tribal enterprises*, Accessed 2026-01-25. Accessed: Jan. 25, 2026. [Online]. Available: <https://www.mtewood.com/Content/files/ForestManagementPlan.pdf>.
- [23] *Sustainable forestry - menominee tribal enterprises | menominee tribal enterprises neopit, wisconsin*, Accessed 2026-01-25. Accessed: Jan. 25, 2026. [Online]. Available: <https://www.mtewood.com/SustainableForestry>.

References VIII

- [24] *Regional economic impacts of the menominee tribal enterprises forestry and mill operations - department of planning and landscape architecture*, Accessed 2026-01-25. Accessed: Jan. 25, 2026. [Online]. Available: <https://dpla.wisc.edu/wp-content/uploads/sites/1021/2017/06/08mtevfina1.pdf>.
- [25] *Climate change impacts on menominee nation's forest home focus of nsf funding*, Accessed 2026-01-25. Accessed: Jan. 25, 2026. [Online]. Available: <https://www.psu.edu/news/research/story/climate-change-impacts-menominee-nations-forest-home-focus-nsf-funding>.
- [26] *Menominee tribal enterprises: Responding to oak wilt on the menominee forest*, Accessed 2026-01-25. Accessed: Jan. 25, 2026. [Online]. Available: <https://forestadaptation.org/adapt/demonstration-projects/menominee-tribal-enterprises-responding-oak-wilt-menominee-forest>.

References IX

- [27] *Blue lake rancheria microgrid*, Accessed 2026-01-25. Accessed: Jan. 25, 2026. [Online]. Available: https://bluelakerancheria-nsn.gov/wp-content/uploads/2018/11/BLR_Microgrid_FactSheet.pdf.
- [28] *Developing a low-carbon microgrid on tribal lands: A case study - blue lake rancheria*, Accessed 2026-01-25. Accessed: Jan. 25, 2026. [Online]. Available: https://bluelakerancheria-nsn.gov/wp-content/uploads/2017/08/11_459.pdf.
- [29] *Energy lifeline sector resilience: Low-carbon microgrids blue lake rancheria community development efforts benefit from clean, r*, Accessed 2026-01-25. Accessed: Jan. 25, 2026. [Online]. Available: https://indigenousgov.hks.harvard.edu/file_url/669.
- [30] *Accelerating transition - indigenous clean energy*, Accessed 2026-01-25. Accessed: Jan. 25, 2026. [Online]. Available: <https://indigenoucleanenergy.com/wp-content/uploads/2022/06/ICE-Accelerating-Transition-Data-Report-web.pdf>.

References X

- [31] *Full article: The contribution of green public food procurement to sustainability: Evidence from two case studies in Spain - Taylor & Francis*, Accessed 2026-01-25. Accessed: Jan. 25, 2026. [Online]. Available: <https://www.tandfonline.com/doi/full/10.1080/21683565.2023.2223555>.
- [32] *Dimensions of community well-being today - persistence of good living - NCBI Bookshelf*, Accessed 2026-01-25. Accessed: Jan. 25, 2026. [Online]. Available: <https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/books/NBK593234/>.
- [33] *American Indian removal: What does it mean to remove a people? | overview | Native Knowledge 360°*, Accessed 2026-01-25. Accessed: Jan. 25, 2026. [Online]. Available: <https://americanindian.si.edu/nk360/resources/American-Indian-Removal-What-Does-It-Mean-Remove-People>.

References XI

- [34] *Impact of native american removal | teacher resource*, Accessed 2026-01-25. Accessed: Jan. 25, 2026. [Online]. Available: <https://americanindian.si.edu/nk360/removal>.
- [35] *Cultural landscapes inventory professional procedures guide - nps history*, Accessed 2026-01-25. Accessed: Jan. 25, 2026. [Online]. Available: <https://npshistory.com/publications/landscapes/cli-procedures-guide-2025.pdf>.
- [36] *Honoring tribal legacies: - nps history*, Accessed 2026-01-25. Accessed: Jan. 25, 2026. [Online]. Available: <https://npshistory.com/publications/honoring-tribal-legacies-1.pdf>.
- [37] *Native american veterans - veterans benefits administration*, Accessed 2026-01-25. Accessed: Jan. 25, 2026. [Online]. Available: <https://www.benefits.va.gov/persona/veteran-tribal.asp>.

References XII

- [38] *Disparities in healthcare coverage and access among american indian/alaska native veterans – publication brief - va health systems research*, Accessed 2026-01-25. Accessed: Jan. 25, 2026. [Online]. Available: <https://www.hsrd.research.va.gov/research/citations/pubbriefs/articles.cfm?RecordID=251>.
- [39] *Healthcare disparities for american indian veterans in the united states: A population-based study - pmc - nih*, Accessed 2026-01-25. Accessed: Jan. 25, 2026. [Online]. Available: <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC2926126/>.
- [40] *Ihs and va launch new map application for native veterans | 2023 announcements*, Accessed 2026-01-25. Accessed: Jan. 25, 2026. [Online]. Available: <https://www.ihs.gov/newsroom/announcements/2023-announcements/ihs-and-va-launch-new-map-application-for-native-veterans/>.

References XIII

- [41] *Ltss for native veterans - cms*, Accessed 2026-01-25. Accessed: Jan. 25, 2026. [Online]. Available: <https://www.cms.gov/training-education/partner-outreach-resources/american-indian-alaska-native/ltss-ta-center/focus-areas/native-veterans>.
- [42] *Section xix personnel policies manual - navajo nation government*, Accessed 2026-01-25. Accessed: Jan. 25, 2026. [Online]. Available: <https://www.dpm.navajo-nsn.gov/pages/policies/sections/XIX.html>.
- [43] *The navajo preference in employment act - awd law*, Accessed 2026-01-25. Accessed: Jan. 25, 2026. [Online]. Available: <https://awdlaw.com/articles/navajo-nation-employment-law-a-primer/>.
- [44] *Sche'lang'en village transformational wrap-around program*, Accessed 2026-01-25. Accessed: Jan. 25, 2026. [Online]. Available: <https://lummihousing.com/program/supportive-housing/schelangen-village/>.

References XIV

- [45] *Lummi nation housing authority*, Accessed 2026-01-25. Accessed: Jan. 25, 2026. [Online]. Available: <https://naihc.net/wp-content/uploads/2019/05/AC-2019-May-9-TH-145pm-Rm708-Title-V-Lummi-NBainbridge.pdf>.
- [46] *Free legal services for homeless veterans - my air force benefits*, Accessed 2026-01-25. Accessed: Jan. 25, 2026. [Online]. Available: <https://myairforcebenefits.us.af.mil/Free-legal-services-for-homeless-Veterans>.
- [47] *Debtor's prison for kids? the high cost of fines and fees in the juvenile justice system*, Accessed 2026-01-25. Accessed: Jan. 25, 2026. [Online]. Available: <https://debtorsprison.jlc.org/documents/jlc-debtors-prison.pdf>.
- [48] *15.10.230 monetary civil fines or penalties - yurok tribal code*, Accessed 2026-01-25. Accessed: Jan. 25, 2026. [Online]. Available: <https://yurok.tribal.codes/YTC/15.10.230>.

References XV

- [49] *25 u.s. code §1302 (indian civil rights act): Constitutional rights*, Accessed 2026-01-25. Accessed: Jan. 25, 2026. [Online]. Available: <https://www.law.cornell.edu/uscode/text/25/1302>.
- [50] *Chapter 12.15 eviction procedures - chehalis*, Accessed 2026-01-25. Accessed: Jan. 25, 2026. [Online]. Available: <https://www.codepublishing.com/WA/ChehalisTribe/html/ChehalisTribe12/ChehalisTribe1215.html>.
- [51] *Homeowner assistance fund | u.s. department of the treasury*, Accessed 2026-01-25. Accessed: Jan. 25, 2026. [Online]. Available: <https://home.treasury.gov/policy-issues/coronavirus/assistance-for-state-local-and-tribal-governments/homeowner-assistance-fund>.

References XVI

- [52] *Predatory installment lending in the states: How well do rate caps protect borrowers?* Accessed 2026-01-25. Accessed: Jan. 25, 2026. [Online]. Available: <https://www.nclc.org/resources/predatory-installment-lending-in-the-states-2025/>.
- [53] *Two approaches to economic development on american indian reservations: One works, the other doesn't - honigman*, Accessed 2026-01-25. Accessed: Jan. 25, 2026. [Online]. Available: https://www.honigman.com/media/site_files/111_imgimgjopna_2005-02_Approaches.pdf.
- [54] *Nation building through lands management application of the harvard project on american indian economic development to canada*, Accessed 2026-01-25. Accessed: Jan. 25, 2026. [Online]. Available: <https://jaed.ca/index.php/jaed/article/download/294/272/426>.

References XVII

- [55] Creative Commons, *Attribution 4.0 international (cc by 4.0) — deed*, 2013. Accessed: Jan. 25, 2026. [Online]. Available: <https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/4.0/deed.en>.

CC BY 4.0 license (Onri Jay Benally)

License

This presentation is licensed under the Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 International License (CC BY 4.0). [55]

Attribution

Onri Jay Benally (2026). Reuse is permitted for any purpose, including commercial use, provided appropriate credit is given, a link to the license is included, and changes (if any) are indicated.

Suggested attribution line

“Onri Jay Benally, *Things of Systemic Importance to Tribal Nations and Similar-Sized Geopolitical Entities*, CC BY 4.0, 2026.”